

Taking to the skies
See pages 162–163

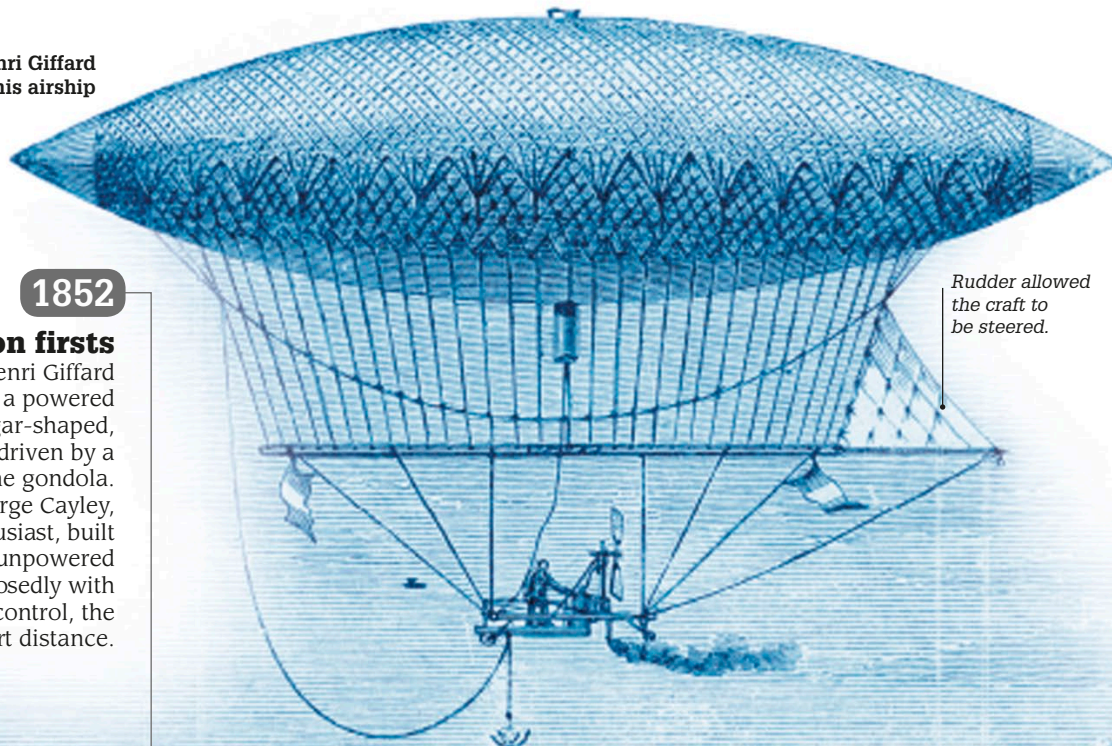
Henri Giffard
in his airship

1852

Aviation firsts

French engineer Henri Giffard flew 17 miles (27 km) in a powered airship (a dirigible). The cigar-shaped, hydrogen-filled balloon was driven by a steam engine mounted in the gondola.

The following year George Cayley, an early aeronautic enthusiast, built the first glider, an unpowered piloted aircraft. Supposedly with Cayley's coachman in control, the glider flew a short distance.



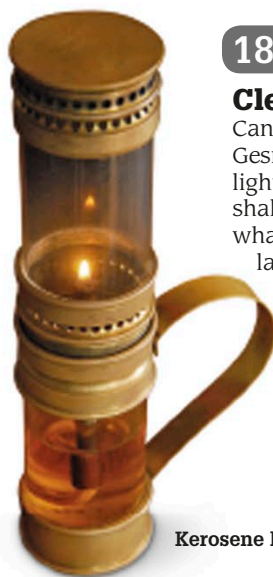
Rudder allowed the craft to be steered.

1855

1853

Cleaner fuel

Canadian geologist Abraham Gesner invented kerosene—a light oil refined from coal and shale. This oil soon replaced whale oil as the fuel burned in lamps for lighting houses and factories, because it was much cheaper and did not smell as fishy.



Kerosene lamp, 1853

1854

Death at the water pump

The London doctor John Snow believed that contaminated water was responsible for spreading cholera (a highly infectious, often fatal disease).

When cholera broke out in London in 1854, he was able to trace the source of the disease to a single water pump. His detective work brought about improvements in sanitation.



An illustration from the time shows Death haunting the water pump that was the source of cholera.



The Bunsen burner, a gas burner used in laboratories, was invented by German chemist Robert Bunsen in 1855.